

# Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow

## PHASE 6: DOCUMENTATION

| Project Detail   | Information                                                  |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Domain           | Information Technology                                       |
| Project Type     | Individual Project                                           |
| Platform         | ServiceNow                                                   |
| Primary Area     | IT Service Management (ITSM)                                 |
| Project Scenario | Corporate VPN incident lifecycle from creation to resolution |

*Prepared as part of the seven-phase project documentation*

## 1. Phase Overview

The documentation phase converts the completed ServiceNow work into evidence that another person can understand and review. Good documentation does more than list configuration steps. It explains why each step was performed, what result was expected, what evidence was collected, and how the project can be reproduced or demonstrated later. This is especially important for an individual project because the document becomes the main record of the work completed.

## 2. Documentation Objectives

- Present the project in the required seven-phase structure.
- Keep the written explanation consistent with the ServiceNow implementation.
- Provide evidence for the major lifecycle stages using screenshots and test results.
- Make the project understandable to a mentor who did not watch the development work being performed.
- Prepare clean material that can be stored in GitHub without exposing credentials or sensitive data.
- Create a clear connection between requirements, implementation steps, testing, and final results.

## 3. Recommended Evidence Set

Screenshots should be selected for their ability to prove an important project outcome. Capturing every click usually makes the report harder to read. A smaller set of well-labeled screenshots is more useful because each image has a clear purpose.

| Screenshot                          | What it should prove                                                                      |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01 - Remote Access service          | The business service used by the incident scenario exists.                                |
| 02 - Corporate VPN service offering | The offering is available and related to the Remote Access service.                       |
| 03 - Incident creation              | The VPN issue has been captured as an incident.                                           |
| 04 - Incident classification        | Network/VPN classification, urgency, service context, and other key fields are populated. |
| 05 - Knowledge / Agent Assist       | Knowledge is used during troubleshooting.                                                 |
| 06 - Reassignment                   | Ownership has moved from Service Desk to Network / Level 2.                               |
| 07 - Level 2 investigation          | Technical work notes or investigation details are recorded.                               |
| 08 - Emergency change               | The change exists and is related to the incident.                                         |
| 09 - Child incident                 | The child record is linked to the parent incident.                                        |
| 10 - Resolution                     | Cause and resolution information are complete and the incident is resolved.               |
| 11 - Knowledge article              | A reusable article has been created from the solution.                                    |
| 12 - Final validation               | Related records and SLA information are visible in the completed lifecycle.               |

## 4. Screenshot Writing Style

Each screenshot should have a short caption that explains what the reviewer is seeing and why it matters. A caption such as “Incident screen” is too weak because it does not explain the result. A stronger caption would be: “The incident is classified as Network > VPN and associated with the Corporate VPN service offering

before escalation to the Network team.” This style makes the documentation easier to evaluate without forcing the mentor to interpret every field independently.

## 5. Test Case Documentation

| Test ID | Test scenario                                             | Expected result                                                        | Status to record |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| TC-01   | Create or verify Remote Access and Corporate VPN records. | Service and offering are available for incident selection.             | Pass             |
| TC-02   | Create the Corporate VPN incident.                        | Incident is saved with a unique number and correct description.        | Pass             |
| TC-03   | Classify the incident.                                    | Network, VPN, urgency, and service context are stored correctly.       | Pass             |
| TC-04   | Search knowledge / use Agent Assist.                      | Relevant troubleshooting knowledge can be reviewed.                    | Pass             |
| TC-05   | Reassign to Network / Level 2.                            | Assignment group changes and history is preserved.                     | Pass             |
| TC-06   | Create emergency change.                                  | Change record is linked to the parent incident.                        | Pass             |
| TC-07   | Create child incident.                                    | Child record is related to the parent incident.                        | Pass             |
| TC-08   | Resolve incident.                                         | Cause and resolution information are saved and state becomes resolved. | Pass             |
| TC-09   | Create knowledge article.                                 | Knowledge article contains the verified solution.                      | Pass             |
| TC-10   | Perform final validation.                                 | Parent, child, change, knowledge, and SLA evidence can be reviewed.    | Pass             |

## 6. Configuration Inventory

A configuration inventory helps the reviewer understand what records are part of the project and also helps the project owner rebuild the scenario if the training instance is reset.

| Item                  | Project value                                |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Project title         | Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow  |
| Business service      | Remote Access                                |
| Service offering      | Corporate VPN                                |
| Incident category     | Network                                      |
| Incident subcategory  | VPN                                          |
| Urgency               | Medium                                       |
| Initial support group | Service Desk                                 |
| Escalation group      | Network / Level 2                            |
| Related process       | Emergency Change Management                  |
| Related incident type | Child incident                               |
| Knowledge output      | Article created from the verified resolution |
| Validation output     | Related records and SLA information          |

## 7. Results Summary

The completed project demonstrates that an incident can be managed as a connected lifecycle instead of as an isolated ticket. The incident is given service context, classified, supported by knowledge, handed off to a specialist team, connected with an emergency change and a related child incident, resolved with documented cause and solution information, and used as the basis for a knowledge article. Final validation provides evidence that the records remain connected and that SLA information is visible.

## 8. Limitations

The project should be evaluated within the limits of a training or academic ServiceNow environment. The implementation does not automatically represent the governance, integrations, security rules, data volumes, or operational procedures of a production enterprise instance. Features named in the general project brief, such as notifications or approval workflows, should only be described as implemented when they have actually been configured and tested.

- Sample users, groups, and configuration items may differ from those in a real organization.
- The technical VPN fault is represented as a project scenario; it is not a live corporate outage.
- Some ServiceNow workspace features can vary depending on instance release and enabled plugins.
- Production deployment and large-scale change governance are outside the current academic scope unless separately demonstrated.

## 9. Future Enhancements

- Configure and test targeted notifications for assignment changes, major updates, and resolution events.
- Add formal approval logic for change scenarios where approval is required by organizational policy.
- Use Flow Designer to automate repeatable assignment, escalation, or follow-up actions where appropriate.
- Add dashboards for incident trends, SLA performance, knowledge usage, and recurring VPN issues.
- Introduce automated categorization or routing based on incident text if suitable platform capabilities are available.
- Create a structured deployment package and automated test suite for moving the solution between ServiceNow instances.

## 10. GitHub Documentation Structure

The GitHub repository should contain project evidence and documentation rather than ServiceNow credentials. A clean repository also makes the mentor's review faster because important files are easy to locate.

| Path         | Contents                                                                                               |
|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| README.md    | Project overview, objectives, workflow, technologies, setup notes, demo link, and documentation links. |
| docs/        | The seven phase documents and, if required, the final consolidated report.                             |
| screenshots/ | Numbered screenshots showing the important lifecycle stages.                                           |
| demo/        | A text or markdown file containing the demo video link and                                             |

|  |                           |
|--|---------------------------|
|  | a short demo description. |
|--|---------------------------|

## 11. Documentation Quality Checklist

- Use the same project title and terminology in every document.
- Number screenshots and refer to them in the text.
- Do not expose ServiceNow usernames, passwords, tokens, or private URLs that should not be public.
- Explain results in full sentences instead of relying only on screenshots.
- Distinguish completed implementation from planned or future enhancements.
- Check spelling, formatting, page numbers, and file names before submission.

## 12. Phase Conclusion

The documentation phase makes the technical work reviewable and defensible. By recording the configuration inventory, screenshots, test cases, results, limitations, future enhancements, and repository structure, the project becomes easier to evaluate and easier to maintain. The final documentation should allow a mentor to understand the incident lifecycle even before watching the live or recorded demonstration.